

Math 220: Mathematical Reasoning and Proof
Instructor: David Zureick-Brown (“DZB”)

All assignments

Last updated: August 28, 2026

Gradescope code: 8D24GR

Show all work for full credit!

Proofs should be written in full sentences whenever possible.

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Gradescope Instructions for submitting work in Math 220

You will be using the online Gradescope program to submit your homework and exams. These instructions tell you how to sign up initially, and how to submit your written work.

Signing up for Gradescope the first time.

If you haven't used Gradescope for an **Amherst College** course before:

- Go to <http://www.gradescope.com>, click on "Sign up for free" (which may auto-scroll you to the bottom of the page), and select Sign up as [a] "Student".
- In the signup box:
 - Use the course entry code **8D24GR**
 - Use your full name
 - Use your **Amherst College email** address. Or, if you are a Five-College student, use your email address from your own school.
 - Leave the "Student ID" entry blank.
- You will probably get an email asking to set a password for your account, so check your **amherst.edu** email inbox. (Or your email inbox through your own school, for Five-College students.)

Adding Math 220 to Gradescope.

If you **have** used Gradescope for an Amherst course before, and so you already have an account through your **amherst.edu** email, you still need to add Math 220, so:

- Go to <http://www.gradescope.com> and log in.
- Go to your Account Dashboard (click the Gradescope logo at upper left), and click "Add Course" at bottom right.
- Use the course code **8D24GR**

(submission instructions on next page)

Submitting written work

First write it out on paper as you would normally. Then **scan it** to create a PDF. One method for scanning is the smartphone app **DropBox**. It makes nice clear scans, and it saves them directly into a folder so that you can have all your assignments in one place. **CamScanner** is another free scanning App, and there are others, too. **Gradescope** now has its own scanning app. You can also use a printer/scanner if you prefer.

Please be kind to our dear graders and make sure your submission is legible !

In particular, please leave some spacing between separate problems.

If you have a tablet computer, you may write your work there (instead of on paper) and save it as a PDF.

Some of you may know the math formatting package LaTeX and may want to use it in Math 220. That's fine, too; if so, you may write up your work in LaTeX and save the resulting PDF.

In short, any method is fine as long as it creates a legible PDF file and NOT a photo.

For example, if you use the DropBox app, then in your created *Math 220 Homework* Dropbox folder, you can select create (+) at the bottom of the screen and click the *Scan Document* option. Snap a shot of the first page of your homework, and then click [+] to snap shots of any subsequent pages. Do **not** use the *Take Photo* option.

After you have scanned/saved your work as a PDF, submit it on Gradescope as follows:

- Go to <http://www.gradescope.com> and log in.
- Select the course “Math 220, Fall 2026” and the appropriate assignment.
- Select “submit pdf” to submit your work in PDF format. Browse to find your PDF and upload.
- Now it is time to **tag** your problems. **This is an important step**, where you are telling Gradescope which problems are on which page(s).

For each problem, select the pages of your submission where your written solution appears.

I think the easiest thing to do is to click on the page of **your** homework upload where you wrote the given problem, and then click on the assigned problem listed. Repeat for each problem.

You must tag the problems or else you will not get credit for your work.

Gradescope will give you a warning when you go to submit your assignment if you have not selected the pages correctly. If you tag a problem incorrectly, you can fix it by clicking “More” and “Reselect Pages”.

- Click Save or Submit.

After your assignment is graded, you will be able to see your score on the written problems, along with comments, on Gradescope. You should receive an email notifying you when each homework set is graded.

Assignment 1: Introduction to course. First proof.

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, September 4

Suggested readings for this problem set:

- Syllabus: <https://dmzb.github.io/teaching/2026Fall220/syllabus-F26-220.pdf>
- Gradescope instructions (previous page)
- Nothing assigned, but good to start reading Chapter 1

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, September 4, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

Please remember that solutions must be handwritten.

1. Using the definitions of “divides” and “even”, explain why 0 is even. Explain why 7 divides 0, but 0 does not divide 7.
2. Suppose that n is an even integer, and let m be any integer. Prove that nm is even.
3. Suppose that n and m are odd integers. Prove that $n + m$ is an even integer. (Hint: an integer n is odd if and only if there exists an integer k such that $n = 2k + 1$.)
4. After reading the syllabus, write out the statment: “I read the syllabus and am aware of this course’s policies”.
5. Recall that the homework is graded only for completion. If there are particular problems you would like grader feedback on, please list them here.



Assignment 2: Logic. “Direct” proofs

Suggested readings for this problem set: **Finish reading chapter 1**

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, September 11, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. Write the negation of each of the following statements.
 - (a) All triangles are isosceles.
 - (b) Every door in the building was locked.
 - (c) Some even numbers are multiples of three.
 - (d) Every real number is less than 100.
 - (e) Every integer is positive or negative.
 - (f) If f is a polynomial function, then f is continuous at 0.
 - (g) If $x^2 > 0$, then $x > 0$.
 - (h) There exists a $y \in \mathbf{R}$ such that $xy = 1$.
 - (i) $(2 > 1)$ and $(\forall x, x^2 > 0)$
 - (j) $\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta > 0$ such that if $|x| < \delta$, then $|f(x)| < \epsilon$.
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 3: More “Direct” proofs; proof by cases

Suggested readings for this problem set: **Section 5.4**

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, September 18, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 4: Proof by contradiction

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, September 25

Suggested readings for this problem set: Section 1.4, p. 41-42 (stop at Historical Comments)

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, September 25, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 5: Induction

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, October 2

Suggested readings for this problem set: **Section 5.2, p. 159-163**

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, October 2, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





Midterm 1 study guide

In class on Wednesday October 7

Content: The questions will all be either

1. homework problems,
2. suggested problems,
3. problems we worked in class, or
4. minor variations of one of these.

Problems with very long proofs or that involved some unusual trick will not be on the exam.

You are allowed to use any previous problem from class or from the homework (e.g., “additivity of divisibility” or “the 2 out of 3 rule”) on the exam without reproving it, unless otherwise noted on the exam. (E.g., if I ask you to prove “additivity of divisibility” on the exam, you will need to prove this using only the definition of divisibility, and I will remind you of this in the statement of the problem.)

A typical exam will have one or two questions from each week of the course, and this exam will cover **assignments 1-5**. You can expect problems about following:

- Negations
- Give definitions (e.g., divides, rational, subset)
- Direct proofs
- Proof by contrapositive
- Divisibility problems
- Contradiction
- Induction
- True/False problems.

There will be a negation problem, at least one definition, and around 4-6 problems involving proofs (possibly including “prove or disprove” problems).

For definitions, I want a definition, in prose (complete sentences), and I want “just” the definition, and not any additional facts about the definition. (E.g., if you give the definition of rational, do not include that a rational number can be written in reduced form; that is a fact about rational numbers not part of the definition of rational.)





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 6: Set theory. Basic operations. Proofs with sets

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, October 16

Suggested readings for this problem set: Section 2.1, p. 49-57; Section 2.2, p. 61-65 (stop at DeMorgan's laws)

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, October 16, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 7: More sets. DeMorgan's laws. Cartesian Products. Power sets

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, October 23

Suggested readings for this problem set: Section 2.2, p. 65-66; Section 2.3, p. 72, just the part about power sets.

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, October 23, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 8: Introduction to functions; images and surjectivity

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, October 30

Suggested readings for this problem set: Section 3.1, p. 81-90 (stop at “Inverse Image”); Section 3.2, p. 97-100 (stop at Inje

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, October 30, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 9: Inverse Image (or “Preimage”) and Injectivity

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Friday, November 6

Suggested readings for this problem set: Section 3.1, p. 90-92 (stop at the Historical Comments.)

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, November 6, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





Midterm 2 study guide

In class on Wednesday, November 11

Content: The questions will all be either

1. homework problems,
2. suggested problems,
3. problems we worked in class, or
4. minor variations of one of these.

Problems with very long proofs or that involved some unusual trick will not be on the exam.

You are allowed to use any previous problem from class or from the homework (e.g., “ $A \subseteq A \cup B$ ”) on the exam without reproving it, unless otherwise noted on the exam. (E.g., if I ask you to prove “ $A \subseteq A \cup B$ ” on the exam, you will need to prove this using only the definition of subset and union, and I will remind you of this in the statement of the problem.)

A typical exam will have one or two questions from each week of the course. You can expect problems about following:

- Give definitions (e.g., subset, union, intersection, preimage, image)
- Proofs about sets (including power sets)
- Proofs about functions, images, preimages, surjectivity, injectivity

There will be at least one definition, and around 4-5 problems involving proofs (possibly including “prove or disprove” problems).

For definitions, I want a definition, in prose (complete sentences), and I want “just” the definition, and not any additional facts about the definition. (E.g., if you give the definition of rational, do not include that a rational number can be written in reduced form; that is a fact about rational numbers not part of the definition of rational.)





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 10: More injectivity; composition of functions

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Tuesday, 10

Suggested readings for this problem set: Section 3.2, p. 100-105, Section 3.3, p. 110-113

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, November 20, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Assignment 11: Inverse functions

Due by 10:00am, eastern, on Tuesday, December 2

Suggested readings for this problem set: **Section 3.3, p. 113-116**

All readings are from Bonde and Keane, *Introduction to Abstract Mathematics*.

Assignment: due Friday, December 2, 10:00am, via Gradescope (8D24GR):

1. TBA
2. TBA
3. TBA
4. TBA
5. TBA
6. TBA
7. TBA
8. TBA



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.





IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



Final exam study guide

Final exam is TBA

The exam will be available on gradescope, and should be submitted via Gradescope.

Big request: if you are writing your exam in latex or on a tablet, please start each problem on a new page. (My eyes are not very good and this helps a lot when I am grading ≥ 50 exams.)

The **last day of class** is Tuesday, December 10.

The *types* of problems will include a subset of

1. Computations
2. Proofs
3. Algorithms
4. True False
5. Bonus problem

Problems with extremely long proofs or that involved some unusual trick will not be on the exam.

Since this is a take home exam, none of the problems will be identical to homework problems, but many problems will be minor variations of homework or of problems we worked in class.

A good way to prepare is to:

1. Know all of the definitions and terminology;
2. Know all of the statements of theorems, and examples of how we use the theorems;
3. Make a list of all of the different *proof techniques* from class and from the homework and review how those techniques are used in proofs and problems;
4. Practice doing problems “from scratch” and use your solutions as “hints” when you get stuck.

Additionally:

1. You are allowed to use the textbook, lecture notes and any materials from the course website.
2. Using Google or any other online resources is not always a reliable source. Please do not use Chat GPT or any other AI assistants.
3. You are allowed to use Theorems, lemmas, etc from the book or from class as part of your solutions, and you are not required to reprove these during the exam. Please do cite them (e.g., “Proposition 1.3.4 from our book”) or refer to them by name, if they have a special name (e.g., “by the Matrix Tree Theorem”).



IN PROGRESS! Check back later for the final assignment.



4. Do not discuss the problems or their solutions with your classmates.
5. You can always ask me (the instructor) if you have clarifying questions, but asking for hints or asking if a proof is correct is not allowed.

The exam will be **comprehensive**. A typical exam will have a few questions from each week of the course, and there will be more emphasis on content not covered on the midterms. The exam to be around 8-9 problems (some with multiple parts), and 2-3 bonus questions.

Hints

X.X. No hints yet.